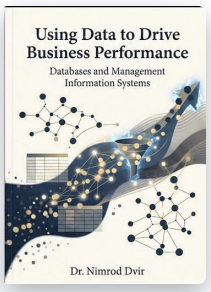
BOOK PROSPECTUS · OCTOBER 2026 · PREPARED FOR CENGAGE

Using Data to Drive Business Performance

Databases and Management Information Systems

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Version 2 · Tested in summer 2026 · In use with 500 students in fall 2026

What this book is

Courseware that teaches business students to turn data into decisions: a textbook, an interactive reader, guided builds, labs, auto-graded quizzes and a semester project, built to run as one course. Students learn to organize data, query it with SQL, check the answers, present them and decide, with AI as an assistant whose work they learn to check.

Data → Tables → Relationships → Queries → Analytics → Decisions

Primary audience	The applied business database or MIS data-management course.
Also fits	The required business-core data or IS course, accounting information systems and analytics foundations, through selectable routes.

How it is different

- **Starts with the business.** Chapter 1 opens with performance, goals and KPIs, before any database theory.
- **Uses a database before designing one.** Data literacy comes first; students query a supplied database, then design their own.
- **Ends in a decision.** Analytics, dashboards and a full Power BI chapter lead to a decision memo.
- **Makes checking AI a habit.** From Chapter 5, an AI Check asks students to accept, revise or reject AI-assisted work.

What exists today

Seven years of teaching this course at the University at Albany to **more than 4,000 students** shaped the book. Version 1 was tested with a small group in **summer 2026**; version 2 is in use with **500 students in fall 2026**. The full textbook is live as an interactive edition, with a Let's Build, a lab and an auto-graded quiz in every chapter, an instructor dashboard, two running cases and an Access route.

The evidence

375,418
U.S. business bachelor's degrees awarded in 2021–22
NCES, Digest table 318.20

85%
of 61 business schools require at least one IS course in the business core
Fustos, Morris and Haga, 2017

52.9%
of 855 U.S. data-analyst job postings list SQL
365 Data Science, 2026

The proposal also rests on **63 syllabi and course documents from 31 institutions** and a chapter-level comparison of the leading textbooks.

Sources: NCES Digest of Education Statistics (2023), table 318.20; Fustos, Morris and Haga (2017), *Business and Management Studies* 3(2); 365 Data Science (2026). Full references online.

The proposed edition: 16 chapters in five parts

Plus a preface, an unnumbered Midterm Integration Studio, a closing chapter on careers and seven appendices.

PART I From Data to Decisions

1 **From Data to Business Performance**
Business, KPIs, DIKW, information behavior, IS and IT

2 **Understanding Data**
Data types, measurement scales, CSV and JSON, data quality

3 **Organizing Data and Information**
Files, metadata, taxonomies, data dictionaries

PART II Databases and SQL

4 **Databases and the Relational Model**
DBMS, keys, relationships, schemas, integrity

5 **SQL Foundations**
SELECT to aggregates, CREATE and INSERT, first AI Check

6 **SQL for Business Analysis**
Joins, GROUP BY, CASE, business measures

MID **Integration Studio A (midterm)**
Review, practice exam, project checkpoint 1

PART III Designing and Running Databases

7 **Database Design: From Requirements to ER Diagrams**
Business rules, Crow's Foot notation, ERD tools

8 **Normalization**
Anomalies, dependencies, 1NF to 3NF

9 **Building and Testing a Database**
DDL, constraints, loading data, integrity tests

10 **Advanced SQL**
CTEs, views, window functions, triggers

11 **Database Administration, Security and Reliability**
Roles, row-level security, transactions, backup

PART IV From Data to Insight

12 **Business Analytics and Decision-Making**
Fair comparisons, causation, the decision memo

13 **Reporting and Data Visualization**
Dashboards, chart choice, honest visuals

14 **Power BI**
Power Query, data model, DAX measures

15 **Big Data, Data Warehouses and AI**
Star schemas, ETL, NoSQL, verifying AI output

PART V Putting It to Work

16 **Capstone: From Data to Decisions**
Problem to database to dashboard to decision memo

END **Closing: Where Data Can Take You**
Data careers and building a portfolio

APPENDICES Tools and routes

A Supabase and the in-book SQL editor · B MySQL route (planned) · C Microsoft Access route · D SQL reference and dialect guide · E Diagramming with Lucidchart · F Tableau route · G Terms Treasury

Every chapter: introduction, core concepts, Terms Treasury, review questions, a Reading Assessment Test, a Let's Build, an interactive lab and key takeaways, plus a three-checkpoint semester project.

Two routes: business core, Chapters 1–8 and 12–14; MIS, Chapter 1 and Chapters 4–16, with Chapters 2–3 as reading. Final pacing to be agreed in review.

Available now

- Textbook and interactive reader
- A Let's Build, a lab and a quiz per chapter
- Instructor dashboard and materials
- Access route; Grading Database and PetVax cases

Planned for the next edition

- The 16-chapter edition above
- In-browser PostgreSQL practice workspaces
- A MySQL route, to be tested on the shared cases
- Automated SQL and lab feedback (prototype in testing)

Three decisions to make together

1 Publishing arrangement and portfolio positioning

2 Development scope: tools, cases and a sample unit

3 Responsibilities, review milestones and manuscript submission

I would like to formalize our publishing relationship and agree on the development scope and manuscript submission timeline.

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Full research, outline and references: https://database-textbook.dimapublishing.com/cengage-prospectus-oyb70aaf/